

Product Design and User Journey Mapping (UX/UI)

A MISK Launchpad Workshop
Alina Verbenchuk



Misk مسك
مؤسسة محمد بن سلمان
Mohammed Bin Salman
Foundation

مسك
الانطلاق
Misk
Launchpad

Alina Verbenchuk

Co-founder @ [Korda.co](https://korda.co) | ex-Google, YouTube
Entrepreneur, Product Leader & Author

- 7+ years at Google, including 5+ years across YouTube's product operations, GTM, and product management
- Former founder of tech career mentorship platform Verbetcetera.com
- Deep expertise in the creator economy and the broader tech ecosystem. Author of "[How Platforms Work](#)"
- Oversaw product launches, scaled programs, and built systems supporting millions of creators worldwide
- Strong background in product management, data-driven decision-making, user research and insights



Agenda

Good product design

It's much more than just the design

User and User Personas

And why they matter the most for product success

Critical User Journeys

How does the product get the job done?

Why UX Matters for Startups

The hidden costs of friction and complexity

User Pain Points

The foundation for your UX mapping

Mini UX Sprint Activities

Hands-on design challenge to apply learnings

**Product Design
isn't just how it looks...**

**It is how it empowers
your users.**



What is a good product design?

Good product design is the intentional shaping of a product so that **users can easily achieve their jobs, with minimal friction, while the product sustainably creates value.**



!!! Important: Don't obsess over UX before you understand your users well



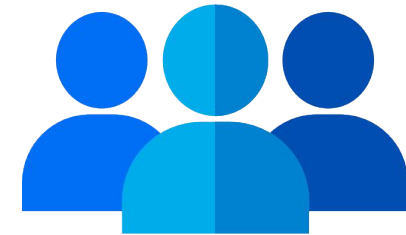
Misk مسك
مؤسسة محمد بن سلمان
Mohammed Bin Salman
Foundation

مسك
الانطلاق
Misk
Launchpad

User and User Personas

And why they matter the most for product success

- ❑ **Goals & motivations** — what they are trying to achieve
- ❑ **Key problems / pain points** — what frustrates them today
- ❑ **Context of use** — when, where, and how they interact with your product
- ❑ **Behaviors & habits** — decision patterns, tools they already use
- ❑ **Needs & expectations** — what “good” looks like for them
- ❑ **Technical proficiency** — beginner, intermediate, advanced
- ❑ **Emotional drivers** — what they fear, value, or aspire to
- ❑ **Barriers to adoption** — what could stop them from using the product
- ❑ **Preferred communication style** — concise, visual, guided, etc.
- ❑ **Triggers** — what makes them seek a solution like yours
- ❑ **Success criteria** — how they define a “win” when using your product



**Detailed behavioral
description is key**

User Pain Points

The foundation for your UX mapping

- Identify moments where users feel **blocked, confused, or overwhelmed**
- Look for steps that cause **delays, rework, or repeated actions**
- Capture frustrations expressed in **user interviews, support tickets, or reviews**
- Observe where users **drop off, abandon tasks, or hesitate**
- Distinguish between **surface pains** (symptoms) and **root causes**
- Document emotional responses — *stress, uncertainty, lack of control*
- Map pains to **specific steps in the user journey**, not general statements
- Prioritize pains based on **frequency, severity, and business impact**
- Identify **workarounds** users create to compensate for poor UX
- Validate pains with **real user behavior**, not assumptions



First, focus on how they do things today

A good personas and pain point description

The foundation for your UX mapping

Archetype	Primary Motivation for Using Korda 5	Core Goals	Primary Administrative Pain Points	Korda Value Proposition
Nova – The Aspiring DIY Artist	Visibility and Career Acceleration 5 . Motivated to "be heard" and prove professionalism 5 6 .	"Be heard" by a wider audience 7 . Prove her professionalism 7 . Turn passion into a sustainable career 7 . Grow a fanbase without signing away rights 7 .	Overwhelmed by all the required steps (distribution, promotion, networking) 7 8 . Fragmentation (juggling multiple sites/spreadsheets) 7 . Technical and industry know-how is a limitation 7 . Anxiety about forgetting something important 7 .	The one-stop solution that guides her 7 . Platform acts as follow-up guidance ("now do X to promote it") 7 8 . Streamlined onboarding (uploading a track in the first session) 7 9 . Provides a sleek public profile (Musician LinkedIn) to appear professional 7 9 .
Aria – The Growing Independent "Propreneur"	Efficiency and Scaling Independence 5 . Motivated by data and efficiency 5 10 .	Streamline and scale up her existing full-time career 11 . Save time on administrative tasks 11 . Consolidate scattered workflows into an efficient system 11 . Achieve an increase in fan engagement and revenue by executing informed campaigns 11 .	"Platform juggling" fatigue (using 5-10 services that don't communicate) 11 . Monetization gaps (low streaming payouts, viewing Spotify as "the McDonald's of music") 9 11 . Limited bandwidth (can't afford a team) 11 . Feels isolated/unsupported 11 .	Acts as the "command center" to centralize distribution and management operations 11 . Provides guidance and best practices (the "virtual label/manager") 11 . Public-facing page that acts as a professional portfolio/EPK 9 11 . Alignment with her ethos of 100% ownership/fair deals 11 .

Marcus – The Emerging Artist Manager	Empowerment and Professional Structure 5 . Motivated by achieving concrete results and scaling 5 12 .	Streamline the business side for his artists 13 . Scale up to manage more artists effectively 13 . Run an efficient micro-label 13 . Professionalize his management process on a budget 14 .	Lack of a centralized system (mix of Sheets, email, separate distro accounts) 13 . Fragmentation risks things "falling through the cracks" 13 . Needs a way to counteract low streaming payouts by finding alternative income 13 . Knowledge gap in areas like optimizing royalties 13 .	Acts as his management cockpit 14 . Allows management of all artists' profiles under one manager account 14 . Public-facing pages as an online resume (Musician LinkedIn) for pitching clients 9 14 . Collaboration tools allowing artists to handle creative tasks while he oversees strategy 14 . Provides industry structure (templates/checklists) 14 .
Dana – The Indie Label Entrepreneur	Sustainability, Scalability, and Ethical Transparency 5 . Motivated by efficiency and eliminating manual admin 5 15 .	Ensure label operations are sustainable and scalable 16 . Improve efficiency in royalty accounting and release management 16 . Educate artists to be more self-sufficient 16 . Achieve measurable success for her artists 16 .	Manual, quarterly headache of consolidating and splitting royalty reports 16 . Fragmented data (logging into multiple distributor/social accounts) 16 . Communication overhead (coordinating release tasks via email threads) 16 . Difficulty in showcasing a professional footprint without enterprise software 16 .	Acts as an integrated label management suite 16 . Provides a unified dashboard to track all artists' key metrics 16 . Centralized distribution for her entire roster 16 . Automation (e.g., royalty report generation) to save hours 16 . Ability to involve artists (logins to view numbers/upload demos) 16 . Alignment with fair practice values (100% ownership) 16 .

Exercise 1: Write out your User Personas and their pain points

3 min



Misk مسك
مؤسسة محمد بن سلمان
Mohammed Bin Salman
Foundation

مسك
الانطلاق
Misk
Launchpad

Why UX Matters for Startups

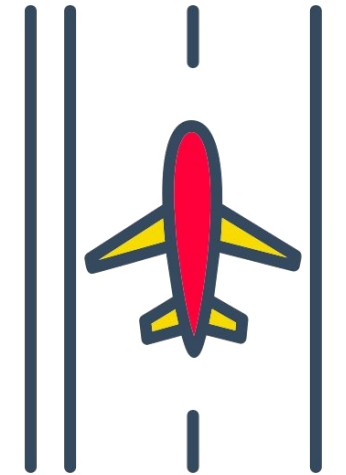
Good UX isn't a "nice-to-have"... it's a survival tool for early-stage growth

Top Friction Killers:

- Confusing onboarding
- Unclear value proposition
- Cluttered interactions

UX is ROI:

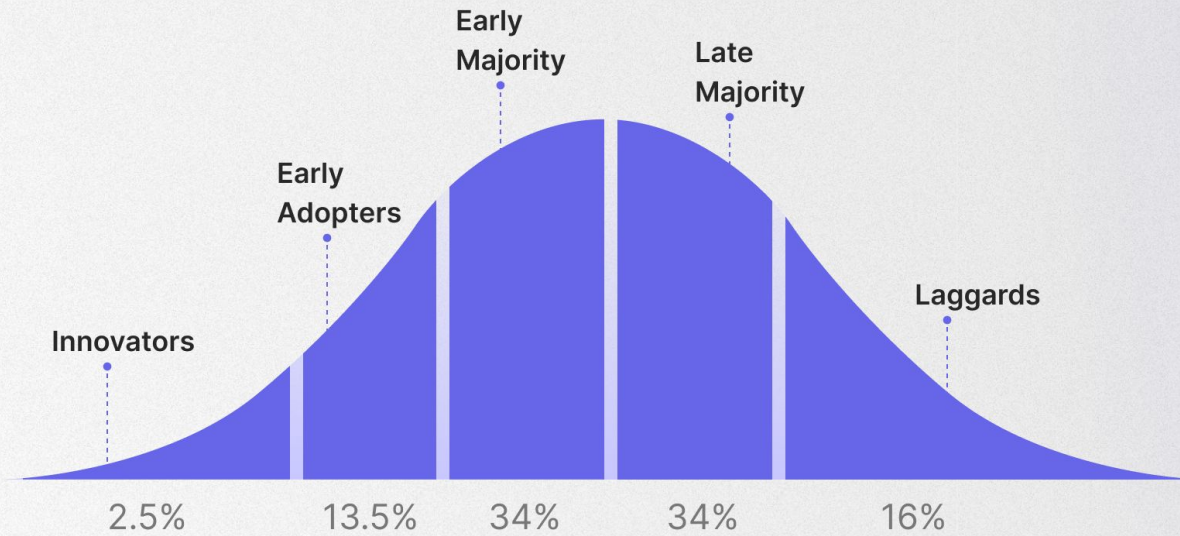
- 88% of users won't return after a bad experience
- Great UX reduces support costs & churn
- Every 1 second of delay = 7% drop in conversions



**Your product's first 5 minutes
define your runway.**



Innovation Adoption Lifecycle



userpilot.com

Critical User Journeys

How does the product get the job done?

Question it answers:

👉 “What steps does the user go through in our product?”

CUJ is about **behavior inside a product**.

- Sequence of actions
- Touchpoints
- Screens / interactions
- Where users succeed, drop off, or get stuck

Example (Spotify):

CUJ:

Open app → Search song → Tap play → Save to playlist

CUJ helps with:

- UX design
- Funnels
- Feature prioritization
- Conversion optimization

Think of CUJ as **the movie of user actions**.

Critical User Journeys

How does the product get the job done?

Aspect	JTBD	CUJ
Focus	Motivation & outcome	Actions & flow
Level	Strategic	Tactical / UX
Product-specific?	✗ No	✓ Yes
Time horizon	Before product exists	After product exists
Used for	What to build & why	How it works

One-liner to remember

- JTBD = “Why was the product hired?”
- CUJ = “How does the product get the job done?”

UX That Moves the Needle — Duolingo Case

Design is what users remember. Great UX becomes your brand.

Before

- Gamified but cluttered interface
- Confusing streak logic & inconsistent tone
- Growth plateaued despite a large user base

Transformation

- Playful, minimal UI & consistent tone of voice
- Created personality for Duo the owl: fun, cheeky
- UX writing reinforcing engagement
- Added bite-sized journeys & feedback loops

Results

- +30% daily active users
- App rating: 4.2 → 4.7
- World's most downloaded education app

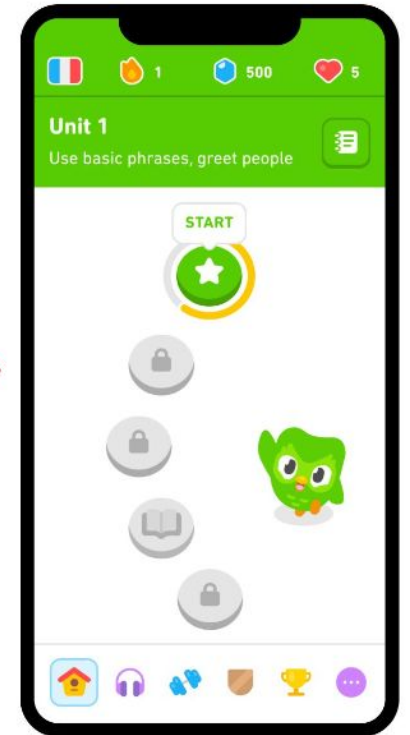
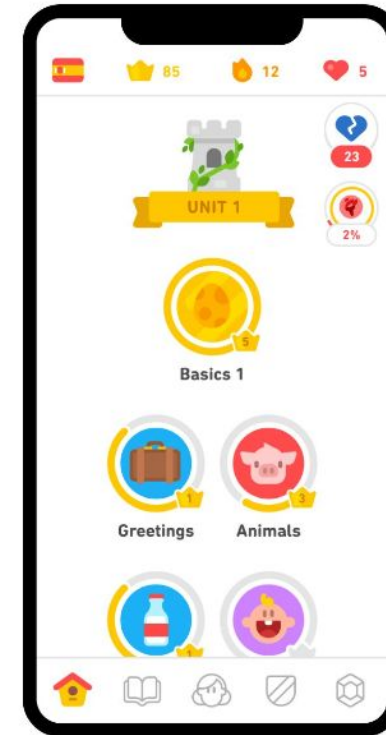
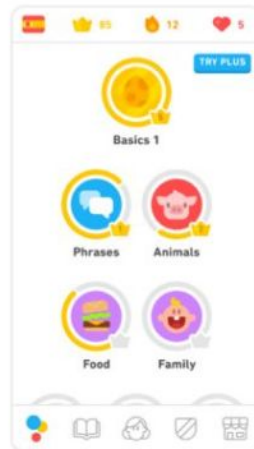
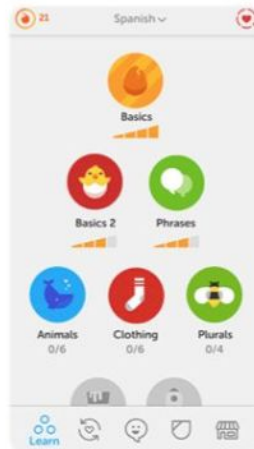
Why It Works

- Brand personality + intuitive UX = emotional hook + retention
- “Learning becomes addictive, not intimidating.”

2012-2014

2014-2018

2018-now



↻ You reposted



Paul Graham ✓ @paulg · Feb 4, 2020



Newly founded startups have no choice but to delight their customers.
They don't have enough power to maltreat them.

One of the most important things the founders can do as the startup grows
is to continue to insist on delighting customers.

💬 50

↻ 523

❤ 2.4K



Misk مسك
مؤسسة محمد بن سلمان
Mohammed Bin Salman
Foundation

مسك
الانطلاق
Misk
Launchpad

Exercise 2: Redesign your onboarding flow

5 min

Design Challenge

Choose one to redesign:

- Your onboarding flow
- Your product's first-use experience

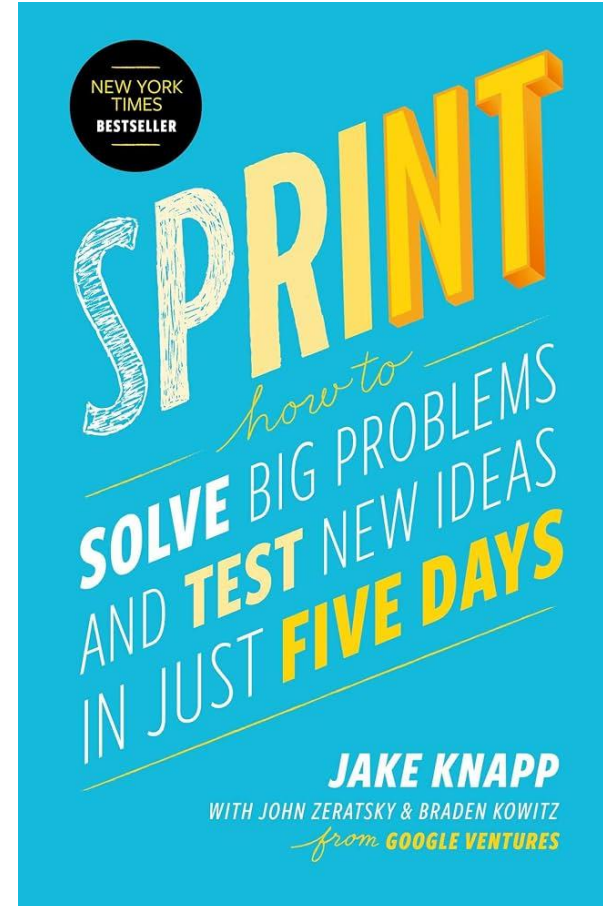
Instructions

- Start with a user goal:
“As a [user], I want to [action] so I can [value].” (user story)
- Sketch 2 screens
- Mark 1 emotion you want them to feel

Wrap-Up + Resources

Recommendations for your products

- [The Design Sprint: How smart teams start big projects](#)
- Lean UX — Jeff Gothelf
- Don't Make Me Think — Steve Krug
- The Mom Test — Rob Fitzpatrick



THANK YOU!

Alina Verbenchuk

alina.verbenchuk@gmail.com

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/alinaverbenchuk/>



Misk مسك
مؤسسة محمد بن سلمان
Mohammed Bin Salman
Foundation

مسك
الانطلاق
Misk
Launchpad





Misk مسك
مؤسسة محمد بن سلمان
Mohammed Bin Salman
Foundation

مسك
الانطلاق
Misk
Launchpad

